

Module 2

Characteristics of Innovative Leaders

TRAITS OF INNOVATIVE LEADERS

By Jack Zenger and Joseph Folkman (Harvard Business Review)

1. Display Excellent Strategic Vision
 - Most effectively describe and explain their vision of the future
 - Excel at creating a vivid, clear picture of the destination:
 - The leader paints the goal clearly, allowing team members to concentrate on figuring out how to get there
2. Have a Strong Focus
 - Attempt to gain deep access into the thoughts, desires, and underlying needs of clients, students, or stakeholders
 - Establish ongoing relationships and continuously inquire about real requirements before drawing conclusions
3. Create a Climate of Reciprocal Trust
 - Innovation inherently carries risk; not every new concept is an immediate success
 - Cultivate friendly, collaborative ties with innovators under their supervision:
 - Make themselves extremely accessible to colleagues and subordinates
 - Colleagues are confident their leader has their back and will never throw them under the bus
 - People are never penalized for making a genuine blunder or honest mistake
4. Put Faith in a Culture That Magnifies Upward Communication
 - Firm conviction that the most inventive ideas emerge from beneath the surface and front-line workers
 - Foster an optimistic culture bursting with energy, humor, and perpetual openness to novel concepts
5. Are Persuasive
 - Highly effective at inspiring others to accept and embrace worthwhile new ideas
 - Never impose or coerce ideals on their teams; present ideas with zeal and conviction so others eagerly listen and buy in
6. Excel at Setting Stretch Goals
 - Establish ambitious targets that necessitate going far beyond simply working harder
 - Drive teams to invent and discover novel approaches to reach challenging benchmarks
7. Are Candid in Their Communication
 - Provide honest, direct, and straightforward critique to help ideas develop
 - Subordinates know they can always rely on their leader for clear, unvarnished answers
8. Inspire and Motivate Through Action
 - Innovation requires motivation rooted in a strong sense of purpose and significance in one's work
 - Lead by example, actively demonstrating dedication through their own daily actions

CASE MODEL: HENRY SY SR. (INNOVATIVE LEADERSHIP IN ACTION)

Reading a Model Text – Real-World Application of Innovative Traits

“It is not wealth that makes a man but his morals.” — Henry Sy Sr.

Henry Sy's 3 Core Pillars (Values & Qualities)

1. Willpower & Resilience
 - Worked since age 12 helping his family survive; survived WWII hardship and shrapnel injury
 - Opened his first store in 1972 – just two months after Martial Law was declared in the Philippines
 - Persevered through the 1980s economic crises, debt moratorium, hyper-inflation, and social unrest
2. Innovativeness & Visionary Thinking
 - Pioneered the country's first air-conditioned shoe store (ShoeMart) in a fashionable format
 - Revolutionized retail by constructing landmark supermalls (including SM Megamall and SM Mall of Asia)
 - Diversified boldly beyond retail into banking (BDO), supermarkets, hardware, appliances, and real estate
3. Corporate & Social Responsibility
 - Funded thousands of college scholarships for underprivileged youth through the SM Foundation
 - Donated numerous public school buildings, modern classrooms, and community libraries nationwide
 - Actively championed environmental protection (promoting reusable eco-bags) and provided disaster relief

LEADERSHIP ASSESSMENT

By Hitesh Bhasin (Marketing91)

- **Definition:** The process of objectively examining and evaluating an individual's distinctive characteristics, strengths, readiness, competencies, and inadequacies as they relate to a leadership role in an organization.
- **Core Diagnostic Value:**
 - **“No Leader Is Flawless”:** Leadership evaluation tells you where you stand in relation to ideal standards. No leader is flawless—every person possesses some leadership attributes, but no one possesses all of them. Assessment replaces subjective guesswork with a reliable feedback mechanism.
 - **Discovering Latent Skills:** Evaluation reveals hidden, unapplied potential and **latent skills** in all facets of life, enabling individuals to capitalize on strengths while addressing vulnerable blind spots.
- **Three Critical Decision Processes Powered by Assessment Insights:**
 - **Selection:** Matching the right candidates with the distinctive leadership criteria required by the organization.
 - **Placement:** Deploying individual strengths where they create maximum impact, synergy, and productivity.
 - **Development:** Formulating targeted training and coaching plans to overcome identified competency gaps.

Primary Benefits of Leadership Assessment

1. Guides in Creating Career Goals

- Provides an unbiased evaluation of leadership capabilities across all professional career stages
- Assists in determining target career roles and how to attain them by evaluating ability to manage diverse responsibilities
- Clarifies necessary management training, experience, and leadership skills required to reach career goals

2. Optimizes Self-Awareness

- Explores personal attributes and leadership qualities essential for effective team management
- Substantially enhances capacity to manage enterprises and interact with stakeholders
- Coordinates skill development while systematically addressing personal weaknesses
- Deeper self-understanding directly elevates overall leadership effectiveness

SELF-ASSESSMENT FOR LEADERSHIP

MSG Management Study Guide

- **Core Concept:** Assessing personal strengths and vulnerabilities to improve overall leadership effectiveness.
- **The Remedial Action Cycle:** Effective leaders realize their vision by encouraging followers toward a common goal. By adopting **Remedial Measures**, they actively reinforce areas of strength and overcome identified deficiencies.
- **Self-Awareness in Practice:** Self-aware leaders monitor personal and professional growth, chart futuristic action plans, and actively hone essential emotional and interpersonal competencies:
 - **Diplomacy:** Tactfully handling sensitive challenges, resolving friction, and fostering collaboration.
 - **Leading by Example:** Demonstrating personal integrity, dedication, and consistency in daily actions.
 - **Empathy:** Understanding the feelings, perspectives, and situations of team members and students.

Advantages of Self-Assessment of Leadership Competencies

1. Source of Motivation

- Leaders track their progress and become internally motivated by celebrating concrete developmental milestones.

2. Direct Competency Feedback

- Delivers clear feedback on how successfully targeted leadership capacities have been strengthened.

3. Promotes Comprehensive Self-Awareness

- Provides an objective accounting of personal and professional strengths as well as vulnerable weaknesses.

4. Hones Inspirational Qualities

- Elevating self-awareness directly sharpens interpersonal diplomacy, empathy, and leadership presence.

5. Informs Strategic Development Plans

- Enables leaders to construct tailored development plans and drive strategies for accomplishing superior performance benchmarks.